



DEPARTMENT OF POLITICAL SCIENCE

COURSE REPORT FOR FIRST CYCLE COURSES IN POLITICAL SCIENCE

The aim of the course report is to demonstrate responsiveness towards the students' views, guarantee the quality of the course, and stimulate subject related and pedagogical development. The report should have a forward-looking focus and be based on the course coordinator's own reflections and input received from students (individually or in groups), teaching staff, education administrators, and the study counsellor, as well as the course evaluation.

Course name: Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA) Course code: SK1136 Semester: Fall Semester 2024		Course coordinator (name and e-mail address): Lisbeth Aggestam lisbeth.aggestam@gu.se
Brief description of course content and structure	The course is the third one in the International Politics track on the second year of the Political Science Program. It was offered for the first time on this program, but has previously been offered to Erasmus and free-standing students. The course introduces students to Foreign Policy Analysis (FPA) as a distinct subfield of International Politics, providing theoretical and conceptual tools to explain foreign policy. Students are expected to learn to apply different FPA models of foreign policy decision-making to empirical cases and to describe the foreign policy-making process and implementation. Teaching includes lectures and seminars with written and oral components.	
Completion rate and grades	Out of 38 registered students, 32 students had completed the course by Mid-March 2025. 12 students received a High Pass, and 20 students received a Pass.	
General and specific impressions of the course	The course structure is well-established and works well with a combination of teaching methods. This semester, there were disruptions at the start of the course due to unforeseen circumstances (a family bereavement) which meant that some lectures and seminars had to be re-organized at short notice. Some of the comments raised in the student evaluation is likely a reflection of this unfortunate situation.	
Students' general impressions of the course	The response rate of the course evaluation was low with only 9 out of 38 students responding, which make it difficult to generalize from students' responses of the course. Students were generally satisfied but noted issues with workload, number of assessments, and access to course literature.	

Students' impressions of specific elements of the course	Lectures were well received and students made favourable remarks about the teachers and the areas of expertise they represent. Comments were raised about more lectures to explain FPA in more depth and empirical cases to illustrate theoretical models. The format of student-led seminars with oral presentation and discussion were rated favourably, but students wanted clearer instructions and more discussion time. The workload was considered demanding, especially over the holiday season of Christmas and New Year. Students commented that they found the workload with several deadlines too demanding for a 7.5 credit course.
Impressions of students' and teachers' views on the administration of the course, incl. Canvas	Mixed feedback on course organization and Canvas information, likely due to the initial disruptions mentioned above. Students want more precise information and instructions for the seminar paper and presentation. Students request earlier publication of essay titles and better access to course literature. There was also a problem for students to access the course textbook as there are limited numbers to borrow from the library and students seem to expect that they should be able access literature online without having to purchase course literature.
Ideas of potential changes for the next round	Based on the student evaluation and feedback, the following changes will be made for the next time the course is running: • Integrate more empirical case studies in the lectures. • Revise seminar instructions to clarify instructions and expectations. • Consider releasing the list of research essay titles earlier. • Update Canvas information and instructions for missed seminars. There were several students on this course that did not attend the compulsory seminars and therefore had to compensate by making extra assignments to be submitted to the seminar teacher. This proved to be demanding administratively.
Ideas of long-term and/or more comprehensive changes	• Replace the final research essay with a written exam. • Maintain compulsory seminars with group presentations but remove individual seminar papers.
Other comments	